

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Saber vs. Saber Cómo Summary

Skool.com/qroo

In this video, I answered a great question from someone in my private learning group, the Qroo Spanish Crew: What's the difference between *saber + infinitive* and *saber cómo + infinitive*?

Here's the simple breakdown I gave:

I use **saber + infinitive** when I'm talking about having the skill or knowledge to do something. For example:

- *Sé cocinar.* – I know how to cook.
- *José sabe hablar español.* – José knows how to speak Spanish.
- *¿Sabes manejar?* – Do you know how to drive?

I use **saber cómo + infinitive** when I'm talking about the **process** or the **method** for doing something. It's not about the general ability—it's about the *how* of getting something done. For example:

- *No sé cómo empezar.* – I don't know how to start.
- *No sabemos cómo llegar a la casa de Juan.* – We don't know how to get to Juan's house.
- *¿Sabes cómo explicar esto?* – Do you know how to explain this?

During the video, I tested you with a few examples so you could focus on spotting the pattern, even if you didn't know all the words. The goal wasn't vocabulary—it was recognizing when to use one structure over the other.

So remember: if I'm talking about a learned skill or general knowledge, I stick with **saber + infinitive**. If I'm talking about how to do something—like the steps or method—I use **saber cómo + infinitive**.